

Informational Text • Informational

Grade	1	Word Count	272
Lexile	490L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level J		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

Many people all over the world speak two languages. They are bilingual. In **Being Bilingual**, readers meet children from different cultures and learn their names and the languages they speak. A pronunciation guide, glossary, and table of contents are included to support readers.

Photo Credits:

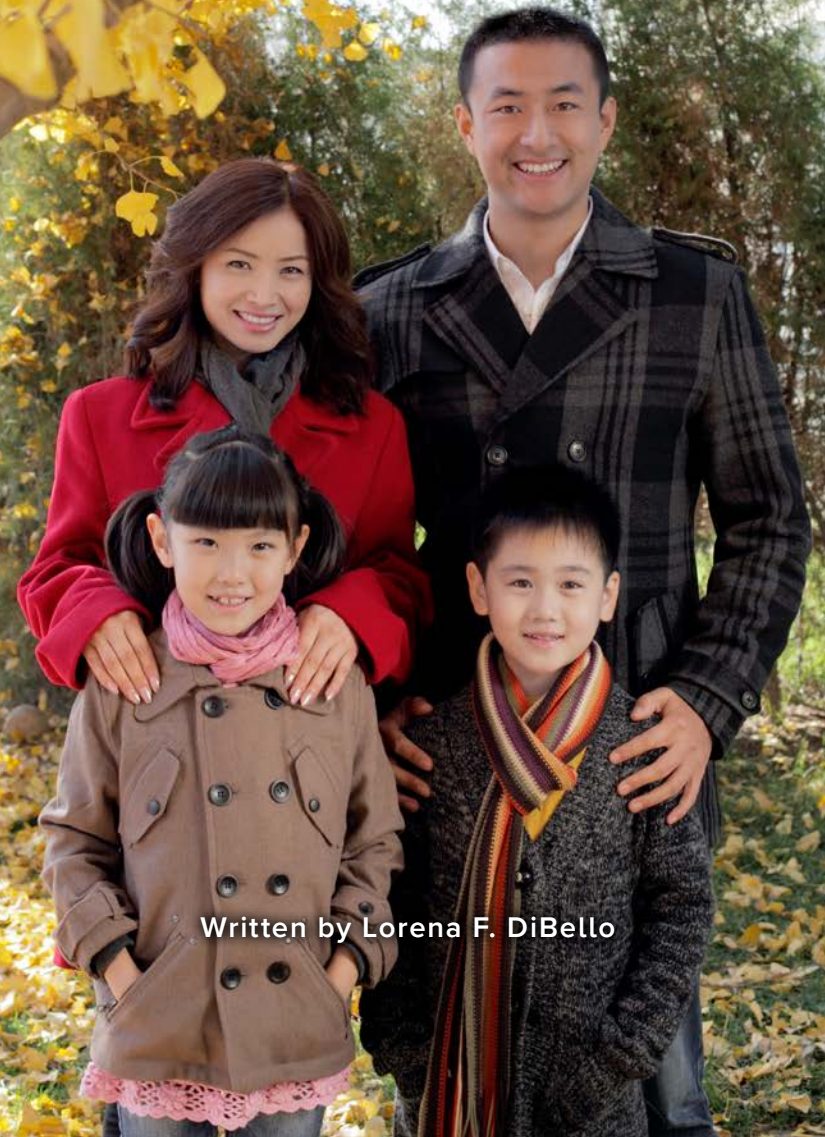
Front cover, pages 6, 7, 15 (top center): © Alex Mares-Manton/Asia Images Group/age fotostock; title page, pages 12, 15 (center): Danita Delimont/Alamy Stock Photo; page 3: © iStock.com/monkeybusinessimages; page 4: © iStock.com/FatCamera; pages 5, 15 (top left): © iStockphoto.com/GreenPimp; pages 8, 15 (top right): © iStock.com/huePhotography; pages 9, 15 (bottom left): © Lawrence Migdale/Science Source; page 10 (both): © Mike Simons/Tulsa World/AP Images; pages 11, 15 (bottom right): Elena Odareeva/Alamy Stock Photo; pages 13, 15 (bottom center): © John and Lisa Merrill/Corbis Documentary/Getty Images; page 14: Sébastien Lecocq/Alamy Stock Photo

Learning A-Z™

For more great books visit
www.learninga-z.com

© Learning A–Z, all rights reserved.

Being Bilingual



Written by Lorena F. DiBello

Being Bilingual



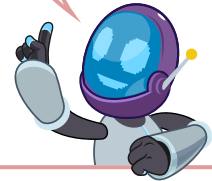
Written by Lorena F. DiBello

Pronunciation Guide

Bengali (ben-GAW-lee)	Mandarin (MAN-duh-rin)
bilingual (by-LING-gwuhl)	Quechua (KECH-wah)
Cantonese (kan-tuh-NEEZ)	Swahili (swah-HEE-lee)
Hindi (HIN-dee)	

Focus Question

Why are some people bilingual?



Words to Know

bilingual	language
Incas	nation
keyboards	weave

Connections

Writing

How is speaking two languages useful? Write a sentence and draw a picture showing your idea.

Social Studies

Choose a country from the book that is different from the one you live in. Find the country on a map. Discuss with a partner what you can learn about the country from the map.



Table of Contents

Introduction	4
French and English	5
Mandarin and Cantonese	6
English and American Sign Language	8
Cherokee and English	9
Hindi and Bengali	11
Swahili and Arabic	12
Quechua and Spanish	13
Conclusion	15
Glossary	16



Introduction

What **language** do you speak?

Do you speak one language
or more than one?

People who speak two languages
are **bilingual**.



French and English

My name is André.

I live in Canada.

I speak two languages.

I speak French and English.

My teachers use French and English
in many classes, such as reading
and social studies.



Mandarin and Cantonese

My name is Lee.

I live in China.

People in different parts of China
speak different languages.



I speak two languages.
I speak Mandarin and Cantonese.
Mandarin is the most used
language in China.



English and American Sign Language

My name is Sam.
I live in the United States.
I am a person with hearing loss.
I speak one language and sign
another.
I speak English and sign American
Sign Language.



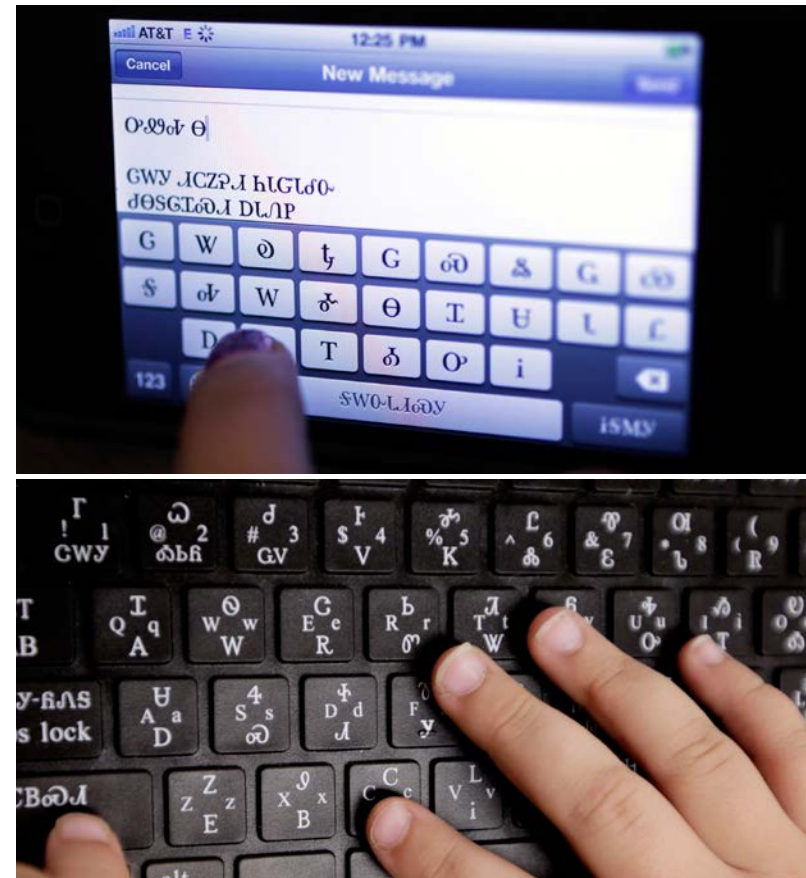
Cherokee and English

My name is Waya, and I am Cherokee.

Waya means “wolf” in the Cherokee language.

I speak two languages.

I speak Cherokee and English.



The Cherokee people are a Native American **nation**.

At home, my family uses special **keyboards**.

We can write in English and in Cherokee.



Hindi and Bengali

My name is Kabir, and I live in India.

People speak many different languages in India.

I speak two languages.

I speak Hindi and Bengali.



Swahili and Arabic

My name is Layla, and I live in Tanzania.

I speak two languages.

I speak Swahili and Arabic.

Swahili is used in many countries in Africa.



Quechua and Spanish

My name is Inti, and I live in Peru.
I speak two languages.
I speak Quechua and Spanish.



Inti means “sun” in Quechua.
Quechua is the language the
Incas spoke.
My mother, grandmother, and I
speak Quechua as we **weave**.



André



Lee



Sam



Waya



Layla



Kabir



Inti

Conclusion

We speak two languages.

We are bilingual!

Being bilingual makes us part
of two worlds.

Glossary

bilingual (*adj.*) page 4

able to speak two languages easily

Incas (*n.*) page 14

a group of people of the Andes
Mountains of South America in the
1400s and 1500s

keyboards (*n.*) page 10

groups of keys laid out in one or more
rows that operate a computer

language (*n.*) page 4

the system used by a culture or country
to communicate

nation (*n.*) page 10

a large group of people who live under
one government

weave (*v.*) page 14

to make fabric by interlacing thread
or yarn